STUDY GUIDE

SOCIAL MEDIA ADVERTISING

How Do You Advertise on Social Media?

Organic Product Promotion

» Tweets, Pins, and Facebook, Instagram, and LinkedIn posts focused on engaging users within the social media platform

» Purpose: Maintains long-term relationship with customers – a natural progression of growth will occur with consistent posting

Content Marketing

» Links pointing an audience to a brand's original content, such as blog posts, videos, and infographics

» Purpose: Distributes relevant and valuable content to increase audience awareness of a brand and educate potential customers about a product or service

Social Campaigns

» Sweepstakes, contests, referral programs, or customer generated content on social platforms

» Can also help get customer feedback or collect pertinent information about their preferences

» Purpose: Opens a dialogue that sparks interest from new customers and keeps current ones engaged with a brand

Promoted Content & Display Ads

» Placements for posts and media purchased to maximize reach and visibility

» Purpose: Targets key demographics with a message curated for a specific campaign

A Closer Look At Advertising Opportunities

Organic Product Promotion

» Standout platforms: LinkedIn and Pinterest

» Best practices for LinkedIn

- Create a strong company page

- Ask for recommendations from standout clients or customers
- Invite your brand ambassadors and industry influencers to follow your page
- Form a LinkedIn group to gather members passionate about topics related to your brand
- Email your members with special promotions (you can email group members weekly)

» Best practices for Pinterest

- Use visually appealing images to showcase your brand and products
- Show customers unique ways they can use your products or services

Content Marketing

» Standout platforms: Facebook and Twitter

» Best practices for Facebook

- Use Page Post Targeting tools
- Handpick your audience, for a price
- Pay to boost a post that will resonate with your targeted audience
- Utilize Page Insights and Audience Insights
- Learn about your audience–their age, gender, location, estimated income, and interests
- Tailor content that will appeal to your audience based on this information

» Best practices for Twitter

- Include high quality images with Tweets
- Make sure your Tweets have a clear call-to-action
- Don't use Twitter solely for content marketing–include variety in your Tweets

Social Campaigns

» Standout platforms: Twitter and Instagram

» Best practices for Twitter

- Ask for creative responses to a prompt, photo submissions, or have the fastest response win
- Provide a specific hashtag when you tweet the contest guidelines

» Best practices for Instagram

- Use "likes" as a contest submission or a comment entry contest
- Hold a photo challenge where people submit using the contest hashtag
- Ask fans to post selfies that incorporate your brand in creative ways

Promoted Content and Display Ads

Facebook

» Most potent paid channel–able to deliver well-targeted impressions

» Power Editor, a bulk ads creation and management tool, is great for hands-on advertisers

Twitter

» Promoted Tweets with cards allow you to add a picture and a call to action button

» Promoted accounts will show up on users' homepages under "Who to Follow"
    - Promoting accounts of your top executives can increase your company's reach; also consider promoting their most engaging Tweets

LinkedIn

» CPC and CPM display ads allow you to target your audience geographically, by company size, title, and industry

» Sponsored InMails are sent every 60 days, and no other brands can send competing InMails during that time

Pinterest

» Promoted Pins show up like regular Pins, but with higher visibility

» When a Promoted Pin is saved on a user's board, it's free advertising

Instagram

» Instagram is owned by Facebook, so you can use Facebook ad creation for your campaigns

» Hashtags highlight your specific campaign

» Call to action buttons available, such as "Install Now," "Learn More," and "Sign Up"

Optimizing Your Content

Variety is Key

» Variety is very important: your customer may be turned off if they feel like every post is pushing them to make a purchase

» Pepper in helpful content tangentially related to your product, like tips or interviews with notable people

Keep it Visual

» The web is becoming increasingly visual, so use stunning images to captivate your audience

» Facebook content performs better if there's an image in the post

Make it Relevant

» Always consider your customer's needs: if the content is relevant and shareable, purchases will come

» Use A/B tests to see which of your content gets the most clicks, likes, comments, or shares to Identify what resonates with your audience

Target, Target, Target

» Reaching primed customers will translate advertising efforts into sales

» Distinguish exactly who you're targeting with an ad campaign, whether it's by demographics, location,

or brand affinities

» Each platform offers unique targeting options – determining how they can target will help you play to each platform's strength

Wrap Up

» Social media is facilitating a two-way dialogue between customers and companies, both large and small.

» Customers can now interact with and directly shape their favorite brands.

» Think about how your users interact with you on social media, and how you can reach them on those platforms through targeted and responsive advertising.

References

» Stay up to date on social advertising by followingSocial Times and Social Media Today.

» Get inspiration on what might stick with your audience by followingJonah Berger, author of Contagious: Why Things Catch On, on his blog.